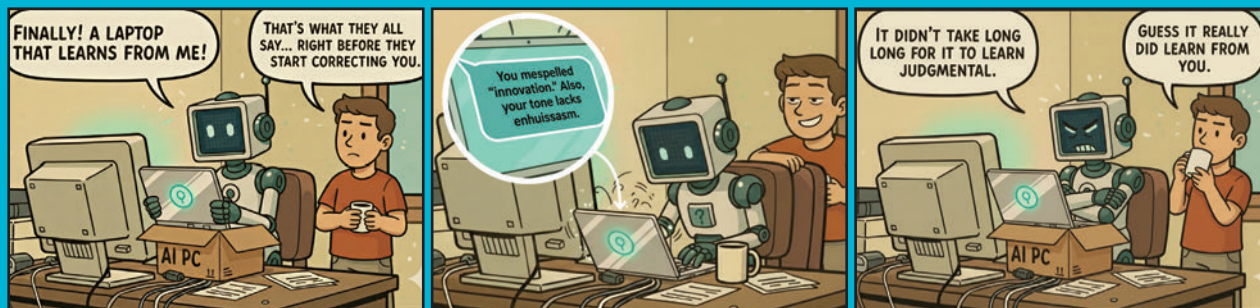


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NotebookLM got some cool new features

Brief and Explainer video formats for dynamic summaries, and more

—By **Vyom Ramani**

Google is pushing its AI research assistant NotebookLM into more creative territory. These upgrades transform NotebookLM from a text-based summarization tool into a more visual, expressive, and storytelling-oriented workspace, one that helps users turn research and notes into engaging multimedia summaries.

NotebookLM's growing creative toolkit

NotebookLM was initially launched as an experimental project to help users “think with their notes.” It analyzes uploaded documents, transcripts, or links, and generates context-aware summaries or explanations. Over time, it has evolved into a full-fledged AI notebook capable not just of summarizing, but of connecting ideas and producing shareable content.

The newest update expands that mission by adding two new video overview formats and a range of AI-generated visual styles, making it easier to personalize how information is presented.

Two new video formats: Brief and Explainer

Until now, NotebookLM generated a single type of video overview: a standard AI-narrated summary based on your sources. With the update, users can now choose between two presentation formats – Brief and Explainer.



Brief offers a condensed, bite-sized summary ideal for quick updates, news briefs, or meeting recaps. It focuses on the key points, stripping away excess context.

Explainer, on the other hand, dives deeper. It connects ideas, outlines reasoning, and adds narrative flow, perfect for class notes, research digests, or concept breakdowns.

Six new visual styles powered by Nano Banana

A standout addition is the integration of

Google's Nano Banana image generation engine, a compact model derived from Gemini 2.5 Flash. It powers six new visual styles that completely change how NotebookLM's video summaries look and feel.

There's also an Auto-select option that lets the AI choose the most fitting style based on your content type. Together, these styles make NotebookLM feel more like a creative studio than a research tool.

Smarter customization and controls

Google has also fine-tuned the interface. A pencil icon in the NotebookLM Studio panel now lets users edit overview settings directly. You can select a style, adjust pacing, or regenerate segments.

A new prompt box lets you guide the AI's focus, for instance: “Summarize only from Source 2 and keep the tone conversational,” or, “Make this an explainer with examples from the research paper.” This level of customization helps users craft summaries that match their audience and intent, no matter what they're doing. tinyurl.com/3xn2en78